
MASTER SCOPE OF WORK & TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION

Global Resale Marketplace — Full Build Scope & Delivery Plan

End-to-end functionality flow, technical architecture, team structure, infrastructure, security, and phased delivery for a Vinted-style consumer-to-consumer marketplace launching in selected markets first.

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01 Executive summary & launch approach

This document specifies the complete build of a consumer-to-consumer (C2C) secondhand marketplace — a Vinted-style platform where individuals list, sell, and ship items to each other. The platform holds no inventory; it provides the software, holds payment securely in escrow until delivery, and orchestrates shipping across third-party carriers.

The platform is engineered to be **global-ready from day one** (multi-currency, multi-gateway, multi-carrier, geo-aware) but **launched in selected markets first** to build the two-sided liquidity a marketplace depends on. Launching in one strong market and expanding in waves is how every successful resale platform grew, and it dramatically reduces cost, compliance load, and operational risk.

Recommended first market

A single mature market with strong marketplace-payment support, a deep low-cost carrier network, one dominant language, and clear regulation — the United Kingdom is the strongest candidate, with France, Germany, or the Netherlands as close alternatives. Additional markets are added in later waves as configuration, not new engineering.

Everyone is both a buyer and a seller

A core principle of the platform: there are no separate "buyer accounts" and "seller accounts." Every registered user can both buy and sell from a single account — a user who joins to buy can list an item minutes later, and a seller can purchase from others. This mirrors how Vinted and every major C2C marketplace works, maximises liquidity, and keeps onboarding simple. The interface adapts to whichever action the user is taking; verification requirements step up only when a user starts selling or withdraws money.

What this document covers

Every functional flow (registration through delivery and payout), the wallet and escrow mechanics, security and authentication, government-ID verification, the complete inventory of screens/pages, every user and admin role, the full technology stack and frameworks, Flutter mobile development, infrastructure, the team structure, new differentiating features, the phased timeline, the commercial model, and the third-party services the client pays for directly.

Scope guardrails for launch: (1) same-country transactions only — cross-border shipping, customs, and FX are deferred to a later phase; (2) one launch market first, expansion in waves; (3) a uniform feature set across markets, with only payment and carrier configuration differing per country.

Timeline & commercial model at a glance

The core portal is delivered over **5 to 6 months**, with a further **3 months** for advanced AI features after the first-phase launch. The engagement is billed as a monthly **development fee of \$3,000 per month**, covering the dedicated design, development, testing, and project-management team only. All infrastructure, servers, database, and third-party API/tool costs are paid **directly by the client** on the client's own accounts. The full third-party service list is in Section 16, and the complete payment terms and commercial breakdown are in Section 17.

02 End-to-end functionality flow

The complete lifecycle of a transaction, from a new user arriving to a completed, paid-out sale. Each numbered stage is specified in detail in the sections that follow.

1 Registration & onboarding

User signs up, verifies identity, sets locale (auto-detected by country), and connects a payout method. Detailed in Section 03.

2 Listing creation

Seller uploads photos, adds details (brand, size, condition), sets a price in local currency and a parcel size. Optional AI auto-fill. Detailed in Section 04.

3 Discovery & purchase

Buyer browses, searches, filters, favorites, messages the seller, makes offers or bundles, and proceeds to checkout.

4 Checkout & shipping choice

Buyer enters address; live carrier rates are fetched; buyer chooses a shipping option by price and speed; pays item + shipping + buyer-protection fee. Detailed in Section 07.

5 Escrow hold

Funds are captured and held securely; the seller is not paid yet. Detailed in Section 08.

6 Fulfilment: pickup & delivery

A shipping label is generated for the chosen carrier; seller drops off or arranges pickup; parcel moves through the carrier network; tracking flows back into the app. Detailed in Section 07.

7 Delivery confirmation

Buyer confirms receipt, or an auto-confirm timer triggers after delivery. A dispute may be opened here, freezing the payout.

8 Payout & wallet

Escrow releases funds to the seller's wallet balance; seller can withdraw to their bank. Detailed in Section 08.

9 Ratings & compliance

Both parties rate each other; seller transaction data is logged for per-country tax reporting.

Parallel throughout: the social layer (real-time buyer–seller messaging, follows, favorites, activity feed) and notifications (push, email) run alongside every stage above.

03 User registration & verification

Registration flow

Users register with email/password or social single sign-on (Google, Apple, Facebook). On registration the system auto-detects the user's country via IP geolocation, confirmed by the address they provide, and sets language, currency, available payment methods, and available carriers accordingly. Email and phone verification (OTP) reduce fake and fraudulent accounts. Every account is a **single dual-role account** — the same person can buy and sell without creating a separate account.

Tiered verification (steps up with activity)

Verification is progressive, so buying stays low-friction while selling and withdrawing money are properly secured:

Level	When required	Checks
Level 1 — Basic	To browse and buy	Email + phone (OTP) verification.
Level 2 — Seller	To list and sell	Above + payout method connected + basic profile complete.
Level 3 — Government-ID (KYC)	Before first payout / higher-value selling	Government-issued ID scan + selfie/liveness check, matched automatically. Required to withdraw funds.

Government-ID verification

Because the platform holds and pays out money, sellers must be identity-verified before they can withdraw. The user photographs a government-issued ID (passport, driving licence, or national ID) and takes a live selfie; a verification provider automatically confirms the document is genuine and matches the person (liveness detection prevents photo/video spoofing). This satisfies KYC/AML obligations and is handled by a specialist provider so the platform never stores raw ID documents itself. Recommended providers and costs are in Section 16.

Authentication architecture

- **Token-based auth** using JWT access tokens (short-lived) plus refresh tokens (rotated), so the mobile apps and web client share one secure session model.
- **Password security** with industry-standard hashing (bcrypt/argon2), never plain storage; enforced password strength rules.
- **Social login (OAuth 2.0)** for Google, Apple, and Facebook, reducing signup friction.
- **Two-factor authentication (2FA)** available for account and withdrawal protection.
- **Session management** with device tracking, remote logout, and suspicious-login detection.

Trust tiers: visible verification badges (email, phone, ID-verified, payment-verified) build buyer confidence and are a differentiator versus Vinted's minimal badges. Higher tiers unlock higher selling and withdrawal limits.

04 Listing creation & catalog

Listing flow

- 1 Photos**
Multi-image upload from camera or gallery, with automatic compression and CDN storage.
- 2 Details**
Title, description, category (from a structured tree), brand, size, condition, and color.
- 3 Price & parcel size**
Price in local currency; parcel size/weight tier that determines shipping cost.
- 4 Publish**
Listing goes live, tagged with the seller's country, and enters search and the personalized feed.

Catalog & discovery

The catalog is organized into a category tree (Women, Men, Kids, Designer, Home, Electronics, and so on) plus brand pages. Discovery features include full-text search with filters (size, brand, condition, price, color), sort options, a personalized home feed weighted by recency and relevance, favorites/likes, follow-seller, and saved searches with alerts.

Managing listings (add & edit)

Sellers have a dedicated "add listing" screen and can fully edit any listing afterwards (photos, price, description, category, or availability) from a "my listings" area, or mark items as sold, reserved, or hidden. Listings can optionally pass through a verification step (see below) before becoming fully visible.

Listing verification

To keep quality high and prevent fraud or prohibited items, new listings can be routed through a verification queue reviewed by a dedicated listing-verification officer (see Section 06). Most listings publish immediately; flagged or higher-risk ones are held for review. This protects buyers and the platform's reputation.

AI-assisted listing (differentiator)

An optional AI flow: the seller photographs an item and the system auto-suggests the title, category, brand, condition, and a price based on comparable sales — turning a tedious multi-field form into a near-instant listing. This is the platform's headline "smoother than Vinted" feature and directly increases how much sellers list.

05 Complete page & screen inventory

A full inventory of the screens/pages required across web and mobile. Because every user is both a buyer and a seller, the same account accesses both buying and selling screens. This list scopes the design and build effort and ensures nothing is missed.

A. Public & authentication

Page / screen	Purpose
Landing / home (logged-out)	Marketing entry, featured items, sign-up prompts.
Sign up	Email/social registration.
Log in	Email/social login.
Forgot / reset password	Password recovery.
Email & phone verification (OTP)	Confirm contact details.
Government-ID verification (KYC)	ID scan + selfie/liveness before payout.

B. Browsing & buying

Page / screen	Purpose
Home feed (logged-in)	Personalized listings feed.
Category / catalog browse	Browse by category and brand.
Search results + filters	Search with size/brand/price/condition filters.
Listing detail	Item photos, description, price, seller info, buy/offer.
Seller public profile	Seller's listings, ratings, reviews, badges.
Favorites / likes	Saved items.
Saved searches	Stored searches with alerts.
Cart / checkout	Item + shipping choice + protection fee + pay.
Shipping option selection	Live carrier rates, buyer chooses.
Order confirmation	Post-purchase summary.
Bidding / live auction	Place and track bids (later phase).

C. Selling & listing management

Page / screen	Purpose
Add listing	Create a new item listing (photos, details, price, parcel size).
Edit listing	Update or correct an existing listing.
AI-assisted listing	Photo-to-listing auto-fill flow.
My listings / closet	Manage all of the user's items (active, sold, drafts).
Listing promotion	Bump / spotlight a listing (paid).
Sold items / sales history	Record of completed sales.

D. Orders, shipping & messaging

Page / screen	Purpose
My orders (as buyer)	Track purchases and delivery status.
My sales (as seller)	Track items to ship, in transit, completed.
Order detail + tracking	Unified tracking view for a single order.
Ship item / print label	Generate and download/QR the shipping label.
Messages / chat inbox	All buyer–seller conversations.
Conversation thread	Real-time chat, offers, images.
Dispute / report issue	Raise "not as described," lost, or damaged.
Ratings & reviews	Rate the other party after a sale.

E. Account, wallet & settings

Page / screen	Purpose
Edit profile details	Name, username, photo, bio, preferences.
Add / edit bank account details	Payout bank details (verified) for withdrawals.
Add / edit payment method	Cards/wallets for buying.
Wallet / balance	Pending, available, withdrawn, frozen states.
Withdraw funds	Move available balance to bank (with 2FA/KYC).
Transaction history	All money in/out.
Addresses	Shipping/return addresses.

Page / screen	Purpose
Notification settings	Push/email/SMS preferences.
Security settings	Password, 2FA, sessions/devices.
Language & region	Locale, currency.
Referrals	Invite friends / referral rewards.
Help / support	FAQ, contact support, raise a ticket.
Legal (terms, privacy, tax info)	Policies and per-country tax information.

F. Admin panel (staff-facing)

Page / screen	Purpose
Admin dashboard	Key metrics, activity overview.
User management	View, verify, suspend, and manage users.
Listing moderation / approval	Review and approve/reject listings.
Order & transaction management	View orders, payments, payouts.
Dispute resolution	Handle and resolve disputes/refunds.
Verification queue	Review ID and listing verifications.
Content / CMS & SEO	Manage marketing pages, blog, meta/SEO.
Analytics & reports	Sales, GMV, category performance, tax reports.
Promotions & marketing	Campaigns, banners, featured items.
Roles & permissions	Manage staff accounts and access levels.

Scope note: this is approximately 50+ distinct screens across web and mobile. The exact count is finalised in Phase 0 (design), but this inventory is the basis for the UI/UX and development estimate and confirms the "everyone can buy and sell" model touches both buying and selling screens from one account.

06 User types & admin roles

The platform has one public user type (a dual-role member who can both buy and sell) plus a set of internal staff roles with distinct permissions. Role-based access control (RBAC) ensures each staff member sees and does only what their role allows.

Public user type

Type	Description
Member (buyer + seller)	A single dual-role account. Any member can browse and buy, and can also list and sell. Verification and limits step up as they begin selling and withdrawing. This is the only public account type — there is no separate buyer or seller account.

Internal staff / admin roles

Role	Responsibilities & access
Super admin	Full system access. Manages all staff roles and permissions, platform settings, and has oversight of every module. Typically the owner/founder or lead operator.
Manager / operations lead	Oversees day-to-day operations: orders, disputes, users, and staff activity. Broad access but below super admin; cannot change core system settings.
Listing verification officer	Dedicated reviewer who approves or rejects listings and reviews flagged items in the verification queue — ensures listings are genuine, correctly categorised, and policy-compliant before going fully live.
Identity/KYC reviewer	Reviews government-ID verifications that need manual checking (most are automated), approving sellers for payout. May be combined with the listing verification role for a lean team.
Support agent	Handles customer support tickets, answers user questions, and escalates disputes. Access limited to support tools and the relevant user/order context.
Dispute / trust & safety officer	Resolves disputes, processes refunds, and handles fraud and abuse reports.
Marketing manager	Runs campaigns, promotions, banners, featured items, referrals, and email marketing. Access to the marketing and promotions modules.
SEO / content manager	Manages content pages, blog, and on-page SEO (meta titles, descriptions, structured data) to grow organic traffic. Access to the CMS/SEO module.
Finance / accounts	Views transactions, payouts, fees, and tax reports for reconciliation and reporting. Read access to financial data.
Developer / DevOps (technical)	Maintains the system, deployments, and infrastructure. Not a business role — see Section 14.

Lean-team note: for launch, one person can hold several of these roles (e.g. manager + dispute + KYC reviewer), and a single verification officer can cover both listing and ID checks. The RBAC system is built to support all roles from day one, so responsibilities can be split out to dedicated people as the platform grows — without any re-engineering.

Summary: one public account type (dual-role member) and up to ten internal roles (super admin, manager, listing verification officer, KYC reviewer, support, disputes/trust & safety, marketing, SEO/content, finance, and technical). All are governed by role-based permissions in the admin panel.

07 Shipping: pickup & delivery logistics

The platform does not run couriers. It integrates a multi-carrier shipping aggregator that provides label generation, rate calculation, pickup/drop-off point lookup, and unified tracking across all local carriers through one integration. The buyer chooses their preferred option at checkout.

Buyer chooses shipping at checkout

When the buyer enters their delivery address, the system requests live rates for the listing's parcel size and shows the buyer a list of options with price and estimated delivery speed — for example a cheap locker option, a standard home-delivery option, and a premium tracked/next-day option. The buyer's choice and its cost are added to the order total.

Pickup & drop-off options

- **Drop-off at a locker or parcel shop** — the cheapest, most common option (locker networks, parcel shops).
- **Home collection / pickup** — a courier collects from the seller's address where the carrier supports it.
- **Printerless drop-off** — for digital-label carriers, the seller shows a QR/barcode and staff print the label, so no home printer is needed.
- **Custom shipping** — for oversized items, the seller arranges and prices their own postage.

Delivery & tracking

Once shipped, tracking events flow back from the carrier via webhooks into a single unified tracking view visible to buyer, seller, and support. A strict ship-window timer (e.g. five working days) auto-cancels orders the seller fails to dispatch, protecting buyers.

Recommended shipping providers

Provider	Role
Sendcloud / EasyPost / ShipEngine	Multi-carrier aggregator (one API across all local carriers, labels, rates, tracking). Start here.
Local carriers behind it	e.g. in the UK: Evri, Yodel, InPost, Royal Mail, DPD. Configured per launch country.

Why an aggregator: one integration gives every local carrier with automatic fallback if one is down. Adding a carrier later is a dashboard toggle, not new code — essential for expanding to new markets.

08 Wallet, escrow & withdrawal system

The escrow wallet is the trust backbone of the platform. Buyers' money is held safely and only released to the seller once the item is confirmed received — protecting the buyer from non-delivery and the seller from payment fraud.

How the money flow works

1 Buyer pays

At checkout the buyer pays item + shipping + buyer-protection fee through the local payment gateway.

2 Funds held in escrow

The money is captured and held by the regulated payment provider on the platform's behalf. The seller sees a "pending" amount but cannot withdraw it yet.

3 Item ships & is delivered

Tracking confirms delivery. The buyer confirms receipt, or an auto-confirm timer releases the hold after a set period post-delivery.

4 Payout to wallet

On confirmation, the held amount moves to the seller's available wallet balance. The seller keeps their full sale price (revenue comes from the buyer-protection fee).

5 Withdrawal

The seller withdraws the available balance to their verified bank account. Withdrawals require identity verification and may use 2FA for security.

Wallet states (must be clearly shown to the seller)

State	Meaning
Pending / on hold	Sale made but item not yet confirmed received — cannot be withdrawn.
Available	Delivery confirmed — cleared for withdrawal.
Withdrawn	Transferred to the seller's bank account.
Frozen (dispute)	A dispute is open — funds held until resolved (refund or release).

Regulatory note (critical): the platform must not hold customer funds in its own bank account — in most markets that requires financial authorisation (e.g. FCA in the UK). The escrow hold and payout are handled through a regulated marketplace payment provider (e.g. Stripe Connect), which is the legal holder of funds. The platform orchestrates *when* money releases; the provider holds it. This must be confirmed with a qualified adviser per market.

Refunds & disputes

If the buyer reports "item not as described," lost, or damaged, a dispute freezes the payout. Resolution routes to a full or partial refund from escrow, or release to the seller. At launch, disputes are reviewed manually by the operations team; AI-assisted triage is added as volume grows.

09 New functionality & differentiators

Features that make the platform genuinely better than Vinted, prioritised by impact versus effort. The strategy is to lead with two or three flagship differentiators inside a focused niche, not to spread thin across many small features.

Flagship differentiators (build with the core)

- **AI-assisted listing** — photograph an item, AI auto-fills title, category, brand, condition, and suggested price. The single biggest friction-killer and demo "wow."
- **Trust & authentication** — AI fraud checks at listing time, optional item authentication for designer goods, and visible seller trust tiers. Directly targets Vinted's weakest area and unlocks the luxury niche.

Strong second tier (after the core loop works)

- **Live auction / bidding** — buyers place competitive bids on an item over a set time window, with real-time bid updates and automatic winner selection at close. Drives urgency, engagement, and higher final prices, and is a genuine feature Vinted does not offer. Works especially well for rare, vintage, and designer items.
- **AI-powered search** — natural-language queries ("summer wedding outfit under £40").
- **Video listings** and a **personalized style-based feed** — beat Vinted at discovery.
- **Smart bundling** — the app suggests items that ship together to save on postage.

Quick wins / polish (cheap, high-trust)

- **Faster payouts** with a transparent wallet (clear pending vs available).
- **Frictionless returns** — visibly better than Vinted's return flow.
- **Sustainability layer** — CO₂-saved and resale-value counters that resonate with the resale audience and give marketing hooks.

Phase 3 flagship (later)

- **Live selling / drops** — real-time live-stream selling, a natural extension of the live auction feature. A strong community moat, but heavier to build; scheduled for a later phase once live auction/bidding is established.

Strategic note: these features win only inside a focused niche. "AI-listing + authentication for [specific market] designer resale" is a reason to switch; the same features on a generic everything-marketplace compete head-on with Vinted's user-base advantage and lose.

10 Security architecture

Security is foundational for a platform handling money, personal data, and identity. The following measures are built in from day one, not added later.

Area	Measures
Data in transit	TLS/HTTPS everywhere; certificate management; secure API endpoints only.
Data at rest	Encrypted database storage; encrypted backups; secrets in a secure vault, never in code.
Authentication	Hashed passwords (bcrypt/argon2), JWT with refresh rotation, optional 2FA, OAuth for social login.
Payments	PCI-DSS handled by the payment provider; the platform never stores raw card data; tokenized payments only.
Authorization	Role-based access control (buyer, seller, admin, support); least-privilege on all internal tools.
Application security	Input validation, protection against SQL injection, XSS, and CSRF; rate limiting; bot/abuse protection.
Fraud prevention	Duplicate/stolen-photo detection, suspicious-activity monitoring, velocity checks on new accounts and withdrawals.
Privacy & compliance	GDPR/UK-GDPR compliant data handling, consent management, data-deletion support, per-country tax reporting.
Infrastructure	Firewalls, DDoS protection, isolated environments (dev/staging/prod), audit logging, automated security patching.
Monitoring	Error tracking, uptime monitoring, alerting, and regular backups with tested restore.

Ongoing: security is not one-time. The DevOps/server-maintenance role (Section 14) owns patching, monitoring, backups, and incident response on an ongoing basis.

11 Technology stack & frameworks

The stack is chosen for scalability, a strong developer ecosystem, and a shared backend across web and mobile.

Layer	Technology	Why
Web frontend + admin	Next.js (React)	Fast, SEO-friendly, mature ecosystem; powers both the web app and the admin dashboard.
Mobile apps	Flutter (iOS + Android)	One codebase for both platforms, native performance, faster delivery. Detailed in Section 12.
Backend / API	Node.js (NestJS or Express) or Next.js API	Single API serving web and mobile; strong ecosystem; scales horizontally.
Database	PostgreSQL	Reliable relational database for users, listings, orders, wallet, and transactions.
Real-time	WebSockets / managed realtime	Powers live messaging, typing indicators, notifications.
Search	Algolia / Typesense / Meilisearch	Fast catalog search and filtering at scale.
Media storage	Object storage + CDN (S3-compatible, Cloudinary)	Listing photos and videos served fast globally.
Payments	Stripe Connect (+ regional gateways behind a routing layer)	Marketplace escrow, payouts, KYC; local methods added per market.
Shipping	Sendcloud / EasyPost / ShipEngine	Multi-carrier labels, rates, tracking.
Notifications	Firebase Cloud Messaging, email (SendGrid), SMS (Twilio)	Push, email, and SMS across the lifecycle.
AI features	Vision + language model APIs	AI listing, fraud checks, natural-language search.

Exact framework choices (e.g. NestJS vs Express, Algolia vs self-hosted search) are finalised at kickoff based on budget and team preference; the architecture supports either.

12 Flutter mobile app development

The mobile apps (iOS and Android) are built in Flutter from a single codebase, sharing the same backend API as the web app. This roughly halves mobile development cost and effort versus building two separate native apps while delivering near-native performance.

Mobile app scope

- Full buyer and seller experience: browse, search, list, message, buy, sell, track, and manage the wallet.
- Native camera integration for photo/video listing and AI-assisted listing.
- Push notifications (orders, messages, shipping, payouts).
- Native checkout with the payment provider's mobile SDK (Apple Pay / Google Pay support).
- Location services for address and drop-off point selection.
- Offline-friendly UI where possible; biometric login (Face ID / fingerprint) option.

Delivery considerations

- **App Store & Play Store** submission, review, and compliance (developer accounts required — Apple and Google annual/one-time fees).
- **Staged rollout** — internal test builds, then beta (TestFlight / Play internal testing), then public release.
- **Shared design system** with the web app so branding is consistent across platforms.

Recommendation: web-first for the MVP (fastest path to a working marketplace and easiest to iterate), with the Flutter apps following once the core flows are validated — then maintained in parallel.

13 Infrastructure & server plan

Infrastructure scales with the platform. The plan below starts lean for launch and grows with traffic. Costs are indicative (2026) and vary by provider and usage. **All infrastructure is set up under the client's own accounts and paid directly by the client** — it is not part of the \$3,000/month development fee. This keeps ownership and control of critical services with the client.

Launch-stage infrastructure (single market, early traffic)

Component	Purpose	Indicative cost / mo
Application server(s)	Backend API + web app hosting	\$24 – \$80
Managed PostgreSQL	Primary database (with backups)	\$15 – \$61
Managed database HA (standby)	High availability (recommended before scale)	+\$30 – \$60
Object storage + CDN	Listing photos/videos	\$5 – \$25
Search service	Catalog search (managed or self-hosted)	\$0 – \$50
Cache / realtime	Sessions, messaging, queues	\$15 – \$30
Monitoring, logs, backups	Uptime, error tracking, restores	\$10 – \$30
Launch-stage total	Fully managed, production-ready	~\$110 – \$300 / mo

A lean MVP can start around \$90–\$150/mo (single app server + managed Postgres + storage). High-availability, search, and caching are added as traffic grows. Third-party service fees (payment processing %, shipping labels, SMS, AI API usage) are usage-based and separate from hosting.

Provider recommendation

A developer-friendly, predictable-cost provider (e.g. DigitalOcean) is recommended for launch and early scale — transparent flat pricing and included bandwidth keep bills forecastable. A hyperscaler (AWS) is worth considering later if specific managed services or global regions are needed. The architecture is portable either way.

Environments

Three isolated environments — development, staging, and production — so changes are tested before reaching users. Automated deployment (CI/CD) from the code repository, with rollbacks.

14 Team structure & roles

The build and ongoing operation require the following roles. Team size flexes by phase — smaller for the MVP, scaling up for growth. Roles can be combined for a lean team or split for faster delivery.

Role	Phase	Responsibilities
Project manager / lead	All	Scope, timeline, client communication, coordination across the team.
Backend developer(s)	All	API, database, escrow/wallet logic, payment & shipping integrations, security.
Frontend developer(s)	All	Next.js web app and admin dashboard.
Flutter developer(s)	Mobile phase	iOS + Android apps sharing the backend API.
UI/UX designer	Early + ongoing	User flows, wireframes, visual design, design system, usability. Critical for the "smoother than Vinted" goal.
QA / tester	All	Test plans, manual + automated testing, regression, payment/shipping edge cases, release sign-off.
DevOps / server-maintenance	All (ongoing)	Infrastructure, CI/CD, monitoring, backups, security patching, uptime, incident response, scaling.
Operations / support	Post-launch	Dispute resolution, moderation, customer support (scales with volume).

Lean-team note: for a cost-conscious MVP, a small team can cover this — e.g. one or two full-stack developers, a part-time UI/UX designer, a part-time QA/tester, and a part-time DevOps/server-maintenance person — expanding as the platform grows. A dedicated tester and a dedicated server-maintenance person become increasingly important once real money and real users are on the platform.

15 Delivery timeline & project plan

Delivery is phased so a working marketplace ships early and grows. The core portal is delivered over **5 to 6 months**, with an additional **3 months** for the advanced AI features after the first-phase launch. Durations assume a small focused team and the agreed scope.

Phase	Duration	Deliverables
0 — Discovery & design	Weeks 1–4 (within month 1)	Final scope, UX flows, wireframes, design system, technical architecture, provider selection.
1 — Core build (web-first)	Months 1–4	Registration/auth, listings, search, checkout with buyer shipping choice, escrow wallet, label + tracking, confirm-releases-payout, ratings, admin dashboard. One launch market.
2 — Mobile + launch polish	Months 4–6	Flutter iOS + Android apps, offers/bundles, saved searches, push notifications, seller promotions, full dispute flow, testing, and first-phase launch.
3 — AI features (post-launch)	+3 months after launch	AI-assisted listing, AI-powered search, trust/authentication automation, and AI-assisted fraud and dispute triage.
4 — Scale & new markets	Ongoing (retainer)	Additional markets (config), live auction/bidding, sustainability layer, optimized carrier selection, and (later) live selling.

Summary: core portal live in 5–6 months; advanced AI features delivered over a further 3 months post-launch; new markets and additional features (including live auction/bidding) continue on the ongoing monthly engagement.

16 Third-party services, APIs & client-paid costs

The platform is built on best-in-class third-party services rather than reinventing complex systems (payments, shipping, tax, messaging). This is faster, safer, and industry-standard. **All of the services below are registered under the client's own accounts and paid directly by the client.** They are not included in the \$3,000/month development fee. Our team integrates and configures them; the client owns the accounts and the billing.

Why the client holds these accounts

Keeping payment, hosting, and data accounts in the client's name means the client owns their data, their funds flow, and their infrastructure from day one — with no dependency on the development team for access to critical services. This is the correct, professional structure for a platform handling real money and user data.

Core services required (with purpose & indicative cost)

Category	Recommended provider(s)	Purpose & indicative cost
Payments & escrow	Stripe Connect (+ Mangopay, Adyen, PayPal regionally)	Buyer payments, escrow hold, seller payouts, KYC. Cost: a % + fixed fee per transaction (typically ~1.5–3.5% + small fixed, varies by country/method).
Shipping / logistics	Sendcloud, EasyPost, or ShipEngine	Multi-carrier labels, live rates, drop-off/locker lookup, tracking. Cost: subscription tier and/or per-label fee, plus the postage itself.
Tax information & compliance	Stripe Tax, Avalara, or TaxJar	Automated tax calculation and the data needed for platform tax reporting (DAC7 in EU, 1099-K in US, HMRC in UK). Cost: subscription or per-transaction.
Government-ID / KYC verification	Veriff, Onfido, Persona, iDenfy, or Stripe Identity	Government-ID scan + selfie/liveness to verify sellers before payout (KYC/AML). Cost: per-verification fee (typically ~\$1.30–\$2.50; enterprise providers quote-based). Marketplace-focused options (Persona, Veriff, iDenfy) suit dual-role buyer/seller flows.
Hosting / servers	DigitalOcean or AWS	Application servers and compute. Cost: ~\$24–80+/month at launch, scaling with traffic.
Database	Managed PostgreSQL (DigitalOcean / AWS RDS)	Primary database with backups and high availability. Cost: ~\$15–120+/month.
Media storage + CDN	AWS S3 + CloudFront, or Cloudinary	Listing photos/videos, fast global delivery. Cost: usage-based, ~\$5–25+/month early.
Search	Algolia, Typesense, or Meilisearch	Fast catalog search and filtering. Cost: free self-hosted to ~\$50+/month managed.
Language / localization	Google Cloud Translation, DeepL, or i18n libraries	Multi-language support and auto-translation for a multi-country platform. Cost: usage-based (per character) or free for static translations.

Category	Recommended provider(s)	Purpose & indicative cost
Push notifications	Firebase Cloud Messaging	Order, message, shipping, and payout alerts to mobile apps. Cost: free tier generous; scales with volume.
Email	SendGrid, Postmark, or AWS SES	Transactional email (receipts, verification, notifications). Cost: usage-based, low.
SMS / OTP	Twilio or Vonage	Phone verification and 2FA codes. Cost: per-message fee.
AI features	Vision + language model APIs (e.g. OpenAI, Anthropic, Google)	AI-assisted listing, natural-language search, fraud checks. Cost: usage-based (per request/token).
Maps / geolocation	Google Maps Platform or Mapbox	Address lookup, drop-off point maps, geo-detection. Cost: usage-based with free tier.
Error & performance monitoring	Sentry, Datadog, or built-in provider tools	Error tracking, uptime, performance. Cost: free tier to subscription.
App store accounts	Apple Developer, Google Play Console	Publishing the mobile apps. Cost: Apple ~\$99/year; Google ~\$25 one-time.
Domain & SSL	Domain registrar; SSL via host	Website domain and secure certificates. Cost: domain ~\$10–40/year; SSL usually free.

How this works in practice: at kickoff, we provide the client a checklist of accounts to create (or we create them together under the client's ownership). Our team then integrates and configures each service. The client receives all invoices for these services directly from the providers, keeping full transparency and control. Most services offer free tiers or low usage-based pricing at launch, so early monthly third-party costs are modest and scale only as the platform grows.

Summary of the cost split: the client pays a fixed **\$3,000/month development fee** to our team, and pays the **third-party service providers directly** for hosting, database, payments, shipping, tax, AI, and the other services above. Two clean, separate cost streams — one predictable (development), one usage-based (services).

This Scope of Work is a planning and specification document compiled from publicly available information current as of mid-2026. All costs, durations, framework choices, provider capabilities, and regulatory references are indicative and must be confirmed at project kickoff and with qualified legal, tax, and financial advisers before contracting or launch. Third-party service costs are estimates only, are billed directly to the client by the respective providers, and will vary with usage and provider terms. Timelines and team sizes depend on final agreed scope. All third-party product and company names (Stripe, Stripe Connect, Mangopay, Adyen, PayPal, Sendcloud, EasyPost, ShipEngine, Avalara, TaxJar, Onfido, Veriff, Persona, iDenfy, Stripe Identity, DigitalOcean, AWS, Cloudinary, Algolia, Firebase, SendGrid, Twilio, Google, OpenAI, Anthropic, Flutter, Next.js, PostgreSQL, Vinted, and others) are trademarks of their respective owners, referenced for descriptive purposes only. This document implies no affiliation or endorsement and does not constitute legal, tax, or financial advice.

17 Payment terms, commercial model & investment

This section sets out the commercial terms: the monthly development fee, what it covers, the payment schedule, and how third-party costs are handled. All functionality and planning are specified in the preceding sections; this section covers cost and payment only.

Commercial model & investment

The engagement is billed as a monthly **development fee of \$3,000 per month**. This covers the dedicated team's design, development, testing, and project management for the agreed scope. It is a **development cost only** — all servers, hosting, database, and third-party API/tool costs are separate and paid directly by the client (see Section 16).

Stage	Duration	Development fee
Core portal build	5–6 months × \$3,000	\$15,000 – \$18,000
AI features phase	3 months × \$3,000	\$9,000
Total development (build + AI phase)	8–9 months	~\$24,000 – \$27,000
Ongoing (scale, new markets, support)	Monthly	\$3,000 / month

Figures above are the development fee only. They do not include any infrastructure or third-party service costs, which the client pays directly (see Section 16 for the full list and indicative amounts).

Important — what the \$3,000/month does and does not cover: the monthly fee is purely the *development cost* (the dedicated team's design, engineering, testing, and project management). It does **not** include any third-party or infrastructure costs. Hosting/servers, the database, payment-gateway fees, shipping-label costs, and every third-party API and tool (listed in Section 16) are paid **directly by the client** under the client's own accounts. This keeps ownership, billing, and control of all critical services with the client, and keeps the development fee clean and predictable.

18 Assumptions, risks & next steps

Key assumptions

- The \$3,000/month fee is a development cost only; all infrastructure and third-party services are paid directly by the client on the client's own accounts (Section 16).
- Same-country transactions at launch; cross-border, customs, and FX are a later phase.
- One launch market first, with expansion in waves as configuration.
- Escrow and payouts are handled through a regulated marketplace payment provider; the platform does not itself hold customer funds.
- A uniform feature set across markets; only payment and carrier configuration differs per country.

Key risks (and mitigations)

Risk	Mitigation
Empty-marketplace / low liquidity	Phased single-market launch; focus marketing to build both sides at once.
Regulatory (fund-holding, tax)	Use regulated payment provider; capture tax data from day one; confirm with local advisers.
Payment gateway coverage gaps	Routing layer so gateways can be added per market without rebuild.
Fraud & disputes	KYC before payout, fraud detection, escrow hold, manual then AI-assisted dispute handling.
Support load at scale	Limit concurrent launch markets; scale operations/support with volume.

Recommended next steps

1. Confirm the first launch market and the niche focus.
2. Approve scope and phasing; finalise team size and budget.
3. Begin Phase 0 (discovery & design) to lock UX, architecture, and provider choices.
4. Engage a local adviser to confirm payment and tax obligations for the launch market.